# JBHNTR — Phase 1 GTM Execution Manual

*v2.2 — 20 September 2026. Reconciled with Ettore's clarified founder posture (20 Sep): being credited in the code and on GitHub is fine; what he won't do is carry a "Founder/CEO, JBHNTR" title on LinkedIn or do marketing/PR around himself. That is an open-core, brand-led posture, not stealth, and the document now says so. §12 replaces the former stealth-hygiene section and points to `repo-split-execution-plan.md` for the GitHub work. Everything else carries over from v2.1 (13 Sep decisions: wedge, geography order, LinkedIn from Ettore's own account, partnerships gated on ≥100 activated users, daily digest live).*

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## 0. The order of operations (decided)

Phase 1 runs in four steps. Each unlocks the next; none are skipped.

| Step | What | Unlock condition to move on |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Artefacts + repo split** | Shareable match card, "my market read", invite page, referral controls, measurement plumbing (§4); public-shell/private-engine split and licence change per `repo-split-execution-plan.md` (§12) | Artefacts live; OG images render in LinkedIn/Slack/WhatsApp; production runs on the split repos |
| **2. Social presence + automation** | Brand accounts (§3), directory listings and comparison pages (§6), community participation (§5) fed by the daily draft digest (§9) | Two weeks of karma built; first data post live; digest arriving daily |
| **3. Conversations + referrals** | Ettore's own LinkedIn DMs for PMF interviews (§7.1), in-product interview recruitment, referral loop switched on with intent (§4.3–4.4) | **≥100 activated users**, ≥40 interviews, gate metric read for two weekly cohorts |
| **4. Partnerships** | Coaches, CV services, personality-test sites, interview-prep tools, layoff cohorts, community operators, newsletters (§8) | Gate metric ≥60% "better" so we have a number to pitch with; partner page + stats live |
| **Spikes (any time after step 2)** | Data drop + Hacker News launch (§10) | Data drop after 4 weeks of corpus checks; Show HN after top-3 interview complaints are fixed |

Why partnerships wait: a partner sends their audience once. If the first 50 people hit a product with no social proof, a thin tracker and an untested referral flow, the partner doesn't send again. 100 real users and a gate number ("71% say the shortlist beats their current process") is the minimum pitch.

Why the repo split is in step 1: the public repo is the showcase and the Hacker News audience *will* read it; it has to be the shell-plus-demo-engine version before any spike, and the licence has to be source-available before more code accumulates under MIT.

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## 1. Target definition (confirmed)

**Who:** mid-senior professionals, ~5–15 years of experience, in tech/startup companies and the generalist functions around them: product, engineering (incl. management), data, marketing/growth, sales/revenue, operations/strategy, finance/BizOps, design, people. Not junior/entry-level; not deep specialist verticals (clinical, legal, academic, trades) where our source coverage and matching are weakest.

**Where:** EU, UK, US, Canada — all open from day one, community/partner effort concentrated in sequence, 2–3 weeks each:

| Order | Geography | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | UK + Ireland | English-first, dense London tech scene, heavy layoff-cohort activity, strong niche boards, your time zone |
| 2 | EU remote-first hubs (Berlin, Amsterdam, Lisbon, Barcelona, Paris English-speaking, Nordics) | Home market; GDPR posture is a selling point; competitors are US-centric |
| 3 | US | Largest and most contested; enter with the data drop and Hacker News, not community grind |
| 4 | Canada | Rides on US content; add Canadian subreddits/Slacks once US is live |

## 2. Glossary

| Term | What it is | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| **Hacker News (HN)** | news.ycombinator.com — Y Combinator's discussion site, read daily by millions of tech people and founders. Text-only, honest, allergic to marketing. | A front-page post brings 5–30k visits in 48 h and the sharpest feedback you'll get. |
| **Show HN** | An HN post titled "Show HN: …" where the builder presents what they made and answers questions. You must be the builder and engage; you can't solicit upvotes. | Our launch moment. |
| **Reddit / subreddit** | Topic communities (r/name), each with its own self-promotion rules. | Where seekers actually talk; r/recruitinghell (~2M) is a permanent thread about our exact problem. |
| **Blind** | Work-email-verified anonymous professional community. | We can't post as a brand; users can bring us in. |
| **Product Hunt** | Daily launch site; rewards a visible maker with a face. | Parked (no founder-led marketing). Free "coming soon" listing only. |
| **Directories** | AlternativeTo, There's An AI For That, Futurepedia, SaaSHub, G2, Capterra, BetaList, Uneed… | Free, permanent long-tail traffic from "Jobright alternative" searches. |
| **Data drop** | A short research page publishing one original dataset from our corpus. | Writers cite institutional data without a founder interview. Only we can produce it. |
| **Artefact** | Anything a user shares out of the product carrying our name. | The product does the talking — the core of a brand-led GTM. |

| Term | What it is | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| **Open core** | Public product shell under a source-available licence; the engine (sources, prompts, ingestion) private. | Showcase without handing over the redeployable product. See §12. |
| **Source-available** | Code you can read, modify and run yourself, but not offer as a competing service (BSL 1.1, Elastic 2.0). Not "open source" in the OSI sense — say it accurately. | Our public-repo licence. |
| **Activation** | Profile ≥70% complete **and** first scan run. | The only signup that counts; referrals pay on activation. |
| **K-factor** | New activated users each existing user brings via referral. | Health of the referral loop; ≥0.3 is our Phase 1 bar. |
| **PMF gate** | Deck slide 13: "users consistently say top results beat their existing process." | Phase 1 ends when this holds, not at a user count. |
| **Layoff cohort** | People laid off from one company at once, often in a Slack or public talent directory. | Dense, motivated, time-boxed groups of mid-senior professionals. |
| **Sean Ellis question** | "How would you feel if you could no longer use X?" ≥40% "very disappointed" is the accepted PMF bar. | Second gate metric. |
| **OG image** | The preview image a link shows in LinkedIn/Slack/X/WhatsApp. | Every shared artefact becomes a branded card automatically. |
| **UTM / invite code** | Link tracking parameters and per-cohort signup codes. | Without them we can't attribute users to channels. |

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# 3. Founder posture and brand accounts

## 3.1 The rule (revised 20 Sep)

**Brand-led, not founder-led — and honest about who built it.**

- Ettore is **credited** wherever a builder is normally credited: README, LICENSE, commits, `humans.txt`, the "built by" line in the repo. Phrasing: "Built by Ettore Strapazzon"; never "Founder & CEO".
- Ettore does **not**: put JBHNTR in his LinkedIn headline or experience as Founder/CEO, post about it from his own profile, give interviews, appear in press, or front Product Hunt. Public marketing surfaces speak as the brand.
- No fake accounts, no undisclosed promotion, no persona. Every brand account is openly JBHNTR.

Someone who reads the GitHub repo will find his name; someone who reads the marketing won't. That's the intended shape. Journalists who connect the two get a polite "we're brand-led by choice; happy to answer product questions from the team address."

## 3.2 Voice

Plural brand voice — "we / the JBHNTR team" — on every brand account. Because the code openly credits one builder, brand copy must not claim a team of people that doesn't exist: say "a small, founder-led project" rather than "our engineers".

One private exception: Ettore's own LinkedIn account for one-to-one conversations (§7.1), speaking as himself about "a personal project I'm testing".

### 3.3 Accounts (week 1)

| Platform | Handle | Purpose | Cadence |
|---|---|---|---|
| X | @jbhntr | Data points, anonymised match cards, replies to job-search complaints | 3–5/week |
| LinkedIn Company Page | JBHNTR | Credibility check for seekers; data drops; partner posts reshared. Pages can't DM. Admin identity isn't public; don't list yourself as an employee. | 2–3/week |
| Reddit | u/jbhntr | Disclosed participation. Two weeks of link-free karma first. | 20 min/day |
| Hacker News | jbhntr | Show HN and follow-ups. Bio links the public repo — HN readers will check it. | Launch week |
| GitHub | org `jbhntr` — public `jbhntr/jbhntr`, private `jbhntr/jbhntr-engine` | The showcase and the moat (§12) | Per release |
| Bluesky / Threads | @jbhntr | Cross-post from X | Automatic |
| Email | hello@ / research@ / partners@ on the product domain | Outreach and pitches signed "The JBHNTR team" | — |
| Blog on the domain | /research | Data drops and comparison pages | 1 piece / 3–4 weeks |

Not in Phase 1: TikTok/Instagram/YouTube, full Product Hunt launch, our own Discord.

### 3.4 The "who are you?" paragraph

Use in every bio, FAQ and thread reply:

> JBHNTR is a small, founder-led project built in Europe, currently in private beta. The product shell is source-available on GitHub (github.com/jbhntr/jbhntr) and credits who built it; the matching engine is private. We market as a brand rather than a person by choice. Everything about how matching works, what data we keep and what we refuse to do is on the site — ask us anything about it.

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## 4. Step 1 — build before outreach

### 4.1 Artefact 1: the shareable match card

One job's verdict as a clean image + public link — two scores, fits/watch-out lines, role title, optional company; never the user's name unless they choose.

```
JBHNTR · match card
Senior Product Manager, Payments — Series B fintech, London (hybrid)
Fits what you want ........ 91
You fit what they need .... 74
✓ Remote 2 days, £95–110k, payments domain, scale-up stage
⚠ Asks for 3+ yrs people management; you have 1
jbhntr.app/m/8fk2a  ·  Less searching. Fewer applications. Better matches.
```

Build: public route `/m/{short_id}` (Jinja template); PNG render for OG image and download (Playwright screenshot of the template, cached); "Share" button on every job card and tracker card → copy link / download / LinkedIn / X; company shown by default, toggle to hide; CTA "See your own shortlist — first scan free" with the sharer's referral code embedded. One-line caption suggestion in the share dialog.

### 4.2 Artefact 2: "My market read"

One-page shareable summary after the first scan — the deck's funnel, personalised.

```
Your market read — 12 Sep 2026
We scanned 1,840 live roles matching "senior product / growth, UK or remote EU, £85k+".
   1,840  live roles across 31 sources
     612  passed your hard constraints
     148  semantically relevant beyond the title
      14  worth a decision — two-way fit above your bar
Where the rest fell: 47% location/remote · 29% seniority · 16% salary · 8% domain
Top sources for your profile: company career pages 38% · Otta 21% · LinkedIn 17%
```

Build: template over the scan's stage counts plus a bucketed rejection-reason histogram (the triage model already emits a reason); route `/r/{short_id}`; same OG/PNG treatment; referral embed; "share anonymised" toggle removes salary and location specifics. "1,840 roles, 14 worth it" is the sentence people repeat — and impossible for an auto-apply tool to produce.

### 4.3 Artefact 3: the invite page

`/invite`: code, link, pre-written messages per channel, live counter ("3 friends activated · +N credits"). One post-scan prompt, never nagging: "Know someone else searching? Both of you get credits when they run their first scan."

Pre-written message: *"I'm using JBHNTR for my search — it reads every live role and tells me which handful are actually worth applying to, with reasons. First scan is free and my link gives you extra credits: [link]"*

### 4.4 Referral policy — uncapped earning, controlled abuse

Keep earning uncapped (it's the growth loop) and add controls, because an activation costs us $0.30–1.00 of compute and a farmer with disposable emails inflates the user count and poisons the outcome corpus.

1. **Delayed payout:** credits unlock 48–72 h after activation *and* only after the invitee's first triage action (save/dismiss/apply).

2. **Duplicate check:** near-identical CV embeddings across accounts, same device/IP cluster, disposable-email domains → hold for review. Reuse the existing CV embeddings. *(The heuristics live in the private engine — `referral_hold_reasons()` — so they aren't readable in the public repo.)*
3. **Soft ceiling with human unlock:** first 25 activated referrals/month pay in full; beyond that rewards pause and the user gets "You're referring a lot — tell us who you are and we'll unlock partner status." Converts genuine super-referrers into §8 partners.
4. **Non-transferable, non-refundable** — in the terms.
5. **Leaderboard, not cap:** private monthly "top referrers" email with a small bonus to the top 5.

No hard caps (kill coaches later), no signup CAPTCHAs (kill activation).

### 4.5 Measurement plumbing (same sprint)

Invite codes per cohort mapped to a `source` field; UTM on every outbound link plus a `/go/{channel}` redirect; post-scan gate prompt ("Compared to how you search today, these results are: much better / better / about the same / worse" + optional text); day-14 Sean Ellis email to active searchers; weekly internal metrics view by source (signups, activations, gate answers, referrals sent/activated, K-factor).

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## 5. Step 2 — disclosed community participation

### 5.1 Rules (print them)

1. Answer first, link second, and only when a link *is* the answer or promotion is explicitly allowed.
2. Two weeks of karma before the first link.
3. One account per platform, honest bio. Never a second account; never a friend recommending us on cue.
4. Data, not adjectives.
5. Respect each community's promo rules; use weekly "tools" threads where they exist.
6. Mods are always right.
7. Log every post (the digest in §9 tracks what was drafted; you log what was posted and the UTM).

### 5.2 Where — by geography

| Geo | Reddit | Slack / Discord / other |
|---|---|---|
| UK/IE | r/UKJobs, r/cscareerquestionsuk, r/LondonJobs, r/AskUK (jobs threads) | Otta/WTTJ community, London tech Slacks, Cord community, Product Marketing Alliance, Mind the Product |
| EU | r/cscareerquestionsEU, city subs' jobs threads (Berlin, Amsterdam, Lisbon), r/germany "work" flair | Berlin Startup Jobs, Amsterdam tech Slacks, Lisbon/Barcelona remote-worker Discords, Nordic tech Slacks, Italian tech Slacks |
| US | r/recruitinghell, r/ExperiencedDevs, r/ProductManagement, r/marketing, r/sales, r/FinancialCareers, r/datascience, r/careerguidance, r/Layoffs | Hacker News; Rands Leadership Slack #job-search; Lenny's community; Product-Led Alliance; RevGenius; growth Slacks; Women in Product |
| Canada | r/cscareerquestionsCAD, r/TorontoJobs, r/VancouverJobs | TechTO, Toronto/Vancouver tech Slacks |

| Geo | Reddit | Slack / Discord / other |
|---|---|---|
| All | r/jobsearchhacks, r/resumes (answer only), r/remotework | Layoff-cohort Slacks (§8.2) |

*Verify each community's current rules before investing; Slack names change yearly.*

### 5.3 Examples

Reply, no link (r/recruitinghell, "400 applications, 3 interviews"):

> 400 → 3 is roughly what the data shows. Huntr's Q2 dataset (103k applications) had an 8.1% interview rate for people sending 11–20 applications and 2.9% at 100+. Correlation, not causation, but it suggests the marginal application is close to worthless past ~30. The uncomfortable answer is fewer, better-chosen applications — slower, feels worse, converts better. (Disclosure: we build a tool in this space.)

Data post (self-post, mod-approved beforehand):

> We indexed 41k live EU tech roles for a month. 31% are duplicates and 12% are older than 60 days. Breakdown by country. [method, table, three findings, caveats, "happy to run other cuts"]

### 5.4 Time and targets

20 min/day + one data post/week in the active geography. By day 90: 3,000–6,000 visits, 300–700 signups, ≥3 unprompted mentions/week.

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## 6. Step 2 — directories and comparison pages

**Directories (one afternoon):** AlternativeTo (alternative to Simplify, Jobright, Teal, LinkedIn Jobs, Indeed), There's An AI For That, Futurepedia, Toolify, SaaSHub, G2, Capterra, BetaList, Uneed, MicroLaunch, Product Hunt "coming soon". Same 40-word description and match-card image everywhere. Where a listing asks for a maker, use "JBHNTR team".

**Comparison pages** (you have `/compare/linkedin-jobs`): add `/compare/jobright`, `/compare/simplify`, `/compare/teal`, `/compare/auto-apply-tools` ("why we don't auto-apply" — LinkedIn Apply Assistant + ToS §8.2, Indeed's Apply-for-Me pause; sources in the deck), `/compare/indeed`, plus `/alternatives/jobright`-style pages. Honest tables — they win on X, we win on Y. The digest agent can draft them.

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# 7. Step 3 — conversations and referrals

## 7.1 LinkedIn from Ettore's own account (decided)

Private one-to-one messages only, from Ettore's real profile, which carries **no JBHNTR title** (no "Founder, JBHNTR" in the headline or experience, no posts about it).

**Framing (his words, roughly):** "I'm building a job-search tool as a personal project and testing it privately before deciding whether to make it public. Would you try a free scan on your actual search and give me 15 minutes of honest reaction?"

**Rules:** manual only, ~10–15 messages/day (LinkedIn caps ~100 invites/week; automation gets accounts restricted); target people with #OpenToWork or recent "looking for my next role" posts in the wedge; never a scraped list; accept that the 20–40 people you talk to will know who's behind it — they're users, not the public. If one of them later mentions you publicly, that's fine: the repo already credits you.

**Volume reality:** this yields 8–20 signups/month. Its value is the **interviews**, not acquisition: 20 conversations/week × 8 weeks = 80+ structured PMF interviews. Script: "Would you have found #1–3 yourself?", "Which of the top 10 would you apply to and why not the others?", "What's wrong with #1?", "What are you using today and what does it cost you in hours?"

## 7.2 In-product interview recruitment (regardless)

Post-scan prompt: "Talk to us for 15 minutes about these results → +10 credits." Calendly-style link, video optional. Free and the interviewees are exactly who the gate needs. Reddit DMs from u/jbhntr to people who replied to our threads are the second free source.

## 7.3 Referral loop on

Turn on the §4.3–4.4 mechanics with the first 100 users: invite-only framing, per-cohort codes, weekly K-factor. Below 0.2 → fix the artefacts before adding channels; above 0.5 → pour every channel into it.

## 7.4 Friends-of-friends

Your network can share "a friend is building this". Fast first 30–50 users for interview calibration; biased for PMF — weight accordingly.

**Exit condition for step 3:** ≥100 activated users, ≥40 interviews, two weekly cohorts with a gate reading.

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# 8. Step 4 — partnerships (after ≥100 activated users)

## 8.1 What partners need from us first

Partner emails from `partners@`, signed "The JBHNTR team", are normal B2B. Before they'll send their audience: a working product with social proof, a **partner page** (`/partners`: what they get, how the code works, a one-paragraph blurb and images they can paste), one **stat** ("N users; X% say the shortlist beats their current process"), and a **partner code** that pays referral credits (and cash, if you decide so — §13).

## 8.2 Partner categories, ranked by fit

| Category | Examples (verify) | Why they don't compete | Offer | Priority |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Career coaches / CV writers** | Independent coaches on LinkedIn/Substack with 5–100k followers; CV writers | Paid by the seeker for advice, not tooling; we make their clients faster | Coach account, 100 credits/month for clients, `COACH-NAME` code, disclosure requested | 1 |
| **Layoff cohorts / HR outplacement** | Companies on layoffs.fyi / TrueUp; alumni talent directories; outplacement firms | HR wants a free gesture for leavers; outplacement firms need tools | Cohort code, 30 credits per leaver, blurb for the leaver pack | 1 |
| **Personality / strengths tests** | 16Personalities, Truity, CliftonStrengths-adjacent sites, career-fit quizzes | They end at "here's your type"; we're the "now what" | "Find roles that fit your profile" link with code; potentially type → preferences prefill | 2 |
| **Interview-prep tools** | Final Round AI, Interviewing.io, Exponent, Pramp-style | They start where we end (the application) | Cross-referral: our tracker links them at "interviewing"; they link us at signup | 2 |
| **CV builders** | Kickresume, Rezi, Enhancv (partial overlap on tailoring) | Their core is formatting; ours is choosing | "Where to send this CV" link; careful — adjacent competition | 3 |
| **Salary / comp data** | Levels.fyi, Glassdoor-alt comp sites | They answer "what should I earn", we answer "where" | Salary-floor prefill; cross-link | 3 |
| **Communities and newsletters** | Slack/Discord admins; job-search newsletters 1–20k subs | They need member perks and sponsors | Cohort code; two €100–500 sponsorship tests for a CAC benchmark | 2 |
| **Relocation / visa services** | Jobbatical-style, remote-work relocation | Their users search across borders — our sweet spot | Code + "roles that sponsor" filter | 3 |

## 8.3 Templates

Coach:

> Subject: A tool for your clients' shortlists (free coach account) Hi [name] — we're the team behind JBHNTR, an AI that scans every live role for a candidate and returns the 10–20 worth pursuing, with a two-way fit score and the reasons for/against. No auto-apply; the candidate stays in control. [N] people are using it and [X]% say the shortlist beats how they searched before. We'd like to give you a free coach account (100 credits/month) plus a referral code that earns credits for you and your clients. Try it on one client this week? Reply and we'll set it up in a day. — The JBHNTR team

HR/layoff:

> Subject: Free job-search credits for your leaving colleagues We're JBHNTR, a European AI job-search tool for experienced professionals. We'd like to give everyone affected by the recent changes at [company] a code for 30 free credits (about 6 tailored shortlists) — no strings, no sales calls, no data sharing. Here's a one-paragraph blurb and the code for your leaver pack: [code]. — The JBHNTR team

Personality-test / tool partner:

> Subject: Partnership: from "your type" to "your roles" Your users finish with a profile and a question: what now? JBHNTR answers it — a scan of every live role, filtered to what fits them and what they fit. We'd like to offer your users a code for a free first scan and, if useful, prefill their preferences from your results (with their consent). Happy to share numbers on a call. — The JBHNTR team

### 8.4 Targets

50 coaches contacted → 10 trials → 5 active; 2 layoff cohorts/month; 3 tool partnerships in discussion by day 90. Five active coaches + two cohorts ≈ 300–600 activated users over the following 90 days.

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## 9. The daily draft digest (live since 14 Sep)

A scheduled task runs every day at 07:30 Rome time and emails Ettore a digest: 6–10 fresh Reddit/HN/X threads with draft replies that follow §5.1 (default link-free, disclosure whenever the product is mentioned, rule-check line per draft, priority), a layoff watch with draft HR emails, one X post draft, and a note on anything notable. **Nothing is posted automatically** — Ettore edits/approves and pastes.

Evolution when volume justifies: a small service (Reddit/HN APIs, X API, layoffs.fyi scrape → Claude drafts → Google Sheet queue → approved X posts via API). It belongs in the **private** engine repo or a separate private `jbhntr-ops` repo — never the public shell. Reddit and HN posting stays manual.

Guardrails baked in: no fabricated threads, 10 drafts/day max, never draft twice in a week on the same layoff, never a link where promotion is banned, no emojis/hype.

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## 10. Spikes — data drop and Show HN

### 10.1 Data drops ("JBHNTR Research")

One dataset, one page on /research, one X/LinkedIn thread, one pitch email to 10–15 writers. Candidates in order of press appeal: (1) **ghost and duplicate jobs in UK/EU** — share on 3+ boards, share live 60+/90+ days, by country and function; (2) **the candidate-side funnel** — how 2,000 "matching" roles collapse to ~15 and why; (3) **where the jobs actually are** — share only on company career pages vs LinkedIn vs aggregators.

Steps: SQL → method check → 600–900 words, two charts, methodology box, "request a cut" email → publish Tuesday 08:00 CET → thread same morning → pitches Tue/Wed → Reddit data posts Thu. Outlets (verify current writers): WorkLife, HR Dive, HR Brew, Fast Company Work Life, Business Insider careers, Fortune careers, Sifted, Tech.eu, The Register, Personnel Today, plus the ten biggest job-search newsletters in the wedge. Signed "JBHNTR Research". Interview requests get a written Q&A from the team address, not a person.

### 10.2 Show HN

1. **Prerequisite:** the public repo is the post-split shell with demo engine and BSL/Elastic licence (§12). HN will read the repo; the open-core split is itself a talking point ("why the engine is private").
2. Week 7–8, after ≥4 weeks of interviews and the top-3 complaints fixed, with 100+ real users who can answer in the thread. Tue–Thu, 14:00–16:00 CET.
3. Title: "Show HN: JBHNTR – reads every live job posting and tells you the 10–20 worth applying to".
4. First comment: what it does (5 lines); why no auto-apply; the pipeline and cost per search; what's bad today; "founder-led project, EU-based; the shell is source-available, the engine is private — happy to explain where the line is"; a demo profile with no signup wall. Posting as the builder under a brand handle is fine; if asked "who are you", point to the repo credit — don't dodge.
5. Eight hours in the thread; concede every fair criticism.
6. No upvote requests, no other accounts, no reshares in the first two hours.
7. Expect 1,500–4,000 visits (10–20k if top-5) and the best criticism of Phase 1.

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## 11. Funnel, metrics, calendar

### 11.1 Funnel (ranges, not forecasts)

| Source | Visits | Signups (8–15%) | Activated (50–65%) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Community participation | 3,000–6,000 | 300–700 | 180–420 |
| Show HN | 1,500–4,000 | 150–400 | 80–220 |
| Data drop + press | 1,000–5,000 | 80–400 | 40–220 |
| Partnerships (start ~week 7) | 500–1,500 | 100–300 | 60–190 |
| Directories + comparison pages | 500–1,500 | 40–150 | 25–90 |
| LinkedIn conversations + in-product interviews + friends | — | 80–150 | 70–130 |
| **Direct subtotal** | | **750–2,100** | **455–1,270** |
| Referral uplift at K=0.3 | | +225–630 | +135–380 |
| **90-day total** | | **~1,000–2,700** | **~590–1,650** |

### 11.2 Metrics

| Metric | Target |
|---|---|
| Gate: post-scan "vs. how you search today" | ≥60% better/much better, ≥30% much better, stable across 4 weekly cohorts |

| Metric | Target |
|---|---|
| Sean Ellis at day 14 (active searchers) | ≥40% "very disappointed" |
| Activation | ≥55% |
| Return within 7 days while active | ≥50% |
| Outcome events per active user per week | ≥5 |
| K-factor | ≥0.3 by day 60 |
| Unprompted mentions | ≥3/week by day 90 |
| Interview verdicts | ≥70% "wouldn't have found #1–3 myself" |

Gate holds + K≥0.3 → Phase 2 (paid credits). Gate fails → stop acquiring, fix matching, repeat in the same geography.

### 11.3 13-week calendar

| Week | Build | Outreach | Measure / gates |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Accounts; "who are you" paragraph; invite codes + UTM + `/go/`; gate prompt; **repo split steps 0–2** (`repo-split-execution-plan.md`) | Directory sweep; Reddit karma-building (no links); digest running | Metrics view v0 |
| 2 | Match card share; **repo split steps 3–5** | Karma-building; 10 friends-of-friends interviews | — |
| 3 | Market read; `/invite`; referral controls 1–2; **repo split steps 6–9 (production on new repos)** | UK communities live, first data post; LinkedIn conversations start (10–15/day) | Gate answers weekly from here |
| 4 | Comparison pages ×2 | In-product interview prompt on; interviews 20/week | K-factor v0 |
| 5 | Referral controls 3–5 | EU communities open | Interview synthesis #1 → top-3 fixes |
| 6 | Fix top 3; partner page + stat | EU data post | **Step 3 exit check: ≥100 activated?** |
| 7 | Data drop #1 | **Publish Tue; pitch 15 writers; Reddit Thu.** Partner outreach batch 1 (25 coaches, 3 layoff cohorts) if step 3 exited | Press log |
| 8 | Demo profile for HN | **Show HN**; US communities open | HN complaint list |
| 9 | Fix HN top 3 | Comparison pages ×3; Canada open; partner batch 2 | Unprompted mentions |
| 10 | — | Newsletter sponsorship test #1; personality-test / interview-prep partner emails | CAC benchmark |
| 11 | — | Test #2; coach batch 3 | Gate by channel |
| 12 | Data drop #2 drafting | Kill channels with gate <50% | Sean Ellis read |

| Week | Build | Outreach | Measure / gates |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | — | — | **Phase 2 or matching sprint**; deck §G traction numbers |

Weekly time (solo, with digest): ~8–10 h — 2 h review/post drafts, 3 h conversations, 2 h partner emails (from week 7), 1–2 h metrics. Never cut interviews. The repo split is a one-off ~3 focused days in weeks 1–3, executed by Claude Code from the plan.

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## 12. Open core, licence and legal posture

*Not legal advice; a one-hour session with an Italian lawyer before public launch is worth it. See `italy-legal-commercial-setup.md` for entity options.*

### 12.1 What the split is for

The thing worth protecting isn't the UI or the FastAPI shell — it's the source connectors and ATS integrations, the ranking and triage prompts, the ingestion lanes, dedup, the referral anti-abuse heuristics, and above all the corpus and outcome data that only accumulate with users. So: **public shell + demo engine under a source-available licence; private engine, proprietary.** Anyone can run the product locally on sample data and read every architectural decision; nobody can redeploy JBHNTR as a service without rebuilding the hard part. The split itself is a credible showcase — it shows you knew which 20% was the moat.

Full mechanics, file inventory, interface, build changes and step order: **`repo-split-execution-plan.md`**. Summary of the decisions it implements:

- GitHub org `jbhntr`; public `jbhntr/jbhntr` (fresh, squashed snapshot), private `jbhntr/jbhntr-engine`; old repo → private, renamed `jbhntr-legacy`, archived.
- Public licence **BSL 1.1** (Elastic 2.0 as the simpler alternative); private "all rights reserved". Everything already in the old public history is MIT forever to whoever has it — accept it; the value accumulates under the new licence from day one.
- Production installs the engine at build time with a read-only token; the app refuses to boot in production if it silently falls back to the demo engine.
- Founder credit stays in README/LICENSE/commits/`humans.txt` as "Built by Ettore Strapazzon". Footer says "Source on GitHub" (not "open-source" — it isn't, in the OSI sense).

### 12.2 What "brand-led, not founder-led" means legally

- **Data controller.** GDPR needs a named controller. During private beta, a natural person with a contact email is a valid controller, and your name in a privacy policy is a legal notice, not marketing — consistent with the posture. Update `/privacy` and `/terms` to name the controller and a `privacy@` mailbox before the first cohort beyond friends.
- **Incorporation** is now a liability and payments decision, not a stealth one: do it before Phase 2 (paid credits) and ideally before the data drop/Show HN spikes (weeks 7–8), when press and HN read the footer. Any EU/UK entity puts your name in a public registry — fine under this posture. Don't reach for a US LLC for privacy reasons; the Italian tax-residency issues aren't worth it (see the legal doc).

- **Name protection.** WHOIS privacy on; grab handle and domain variants now. Trademark (EUIPO class 42 + 35, UKIPO, USPTO) — file in the entity's name after incorporation; run a free TMview/USPTO clearance search on "JBHNTR" now. The stylised spelling is the distinctiveness; use it consistently, including the wordmark.

### 12.3 Week-1 checklist (beyond the repo plan)

- Privacy/Terms: controller paragraph + `privacy@` mailbox; remove "template" labels once a lawyer has looked
- WHOIS privacy; handles and domain variants
- TMview / USPTO clearance search
- Incorporation decision calendared for week 5 (vehicle per `italy-legal-commercial-setup.md`)
- LinkedIn: confirm no JBHNTR title on Ettore's profile; company page created with a non-personal admin email

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## 13. Decisions log and remaining questions

**Decided (13 Sep):** wedge and geography order (§1); no part-time person — Ettore's own LinkedIn account for private conversations (§7.1); partnerships as step 4 gated on ≥100 activated users (§0, §8); daily digest live (§9).

**Decided (20 Sep):** brand-led, not founder-led — credit in code and GitHub is fine, no founder/CEO title on LinkedIn, no PR/marketing around the person (§3.1); open-core split with source-available public shell and private engine, executed per `repo-split-execution-plan.md` (§12); GitHub org `jbhntr`.

**Still open:**

1. Public licence: BSL 1.1 (default in the execution plan) or Elastic 2.0? Decide before step 6 of the repo plan.
2. Coach/partner economics when step 4 starts: credits only (default) or credits + a €3–5 cash bounty per activated client?
3. Show HN: fixed to week 8, or conditional on ≥70% positive interview verdicts?
4. Incorporation vehicle by week 5 so the footer names an entity before the spikes.